



LECTURE 13

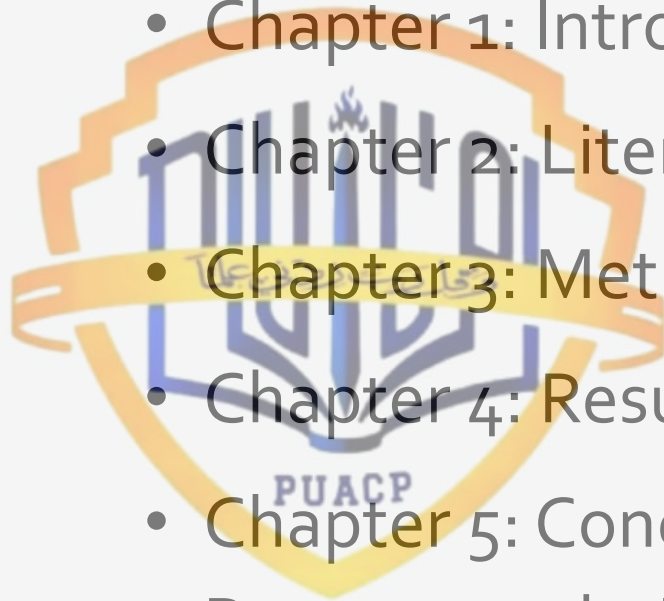


Zeeshan Mahmood Butt
Assistant Professor of Statistics
Govt. College, Gujranwala

*PREPARING
RESEARCH
REPORT*

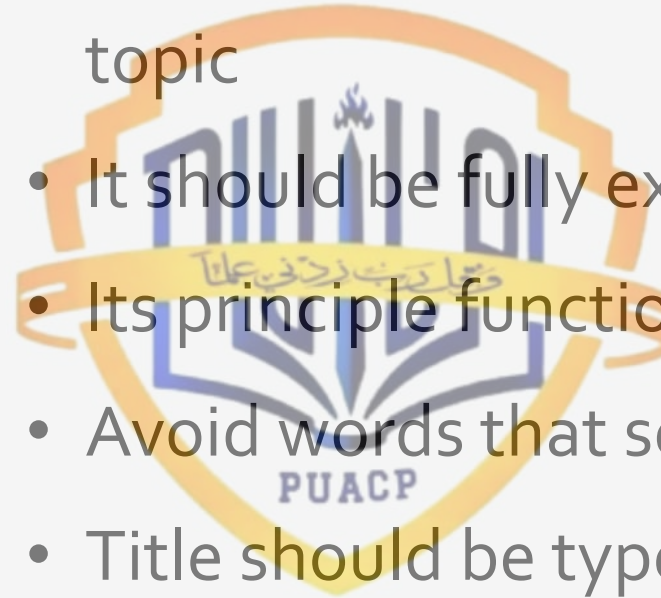
Format of writing research report

- Title
- Abstract
- Chapter 1: Introduction
- Chapter 2: Literature Review
- Chapter 3: Methodology
- Chapter 4: Results
- Chapter 5: Conclusion and Recommendation
- References



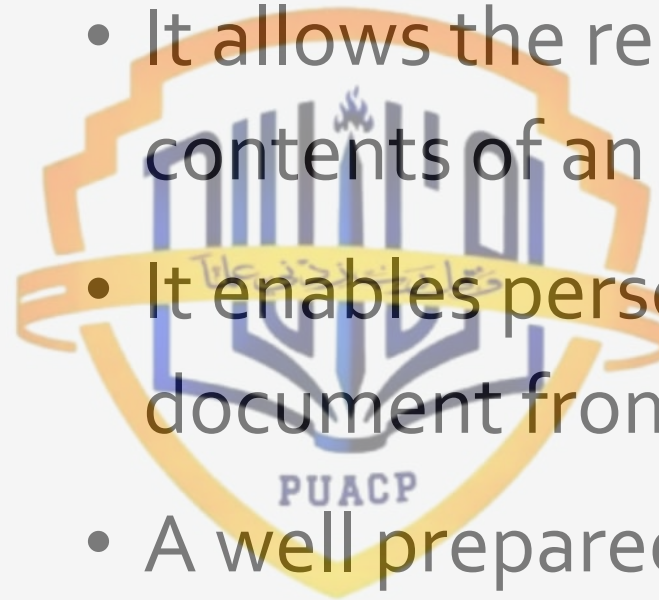
Title

- Title should summarize the main idea of the document
- It should be the brief statement of the main topic
- It should be fully explanatory
- Its principle function is to inform the readers
- Avoid words that serves no useful purpose
- Title should be typed in upper case and lower case letters
- Centered between the left and right margin



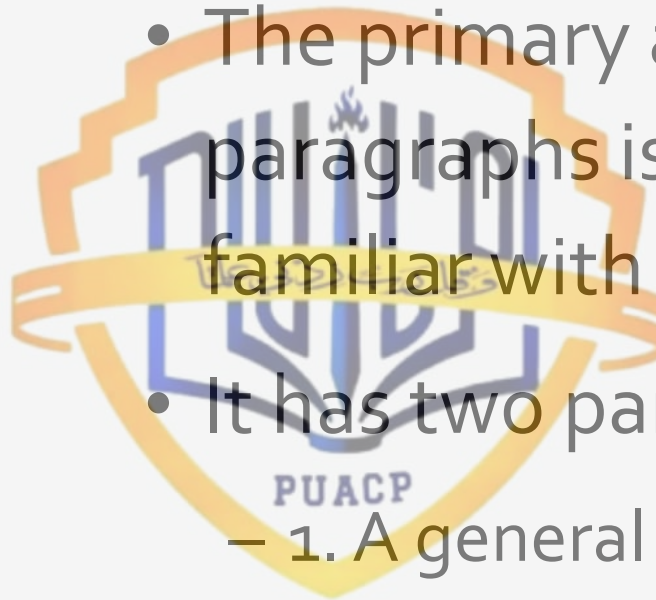
Abstract

- Brief comprehensive summary of the contents of the article
- It allows the readers to survey the contents of an articles
- It enables person to retrieve document from a database
- A well prepared abstract is a single paragraph



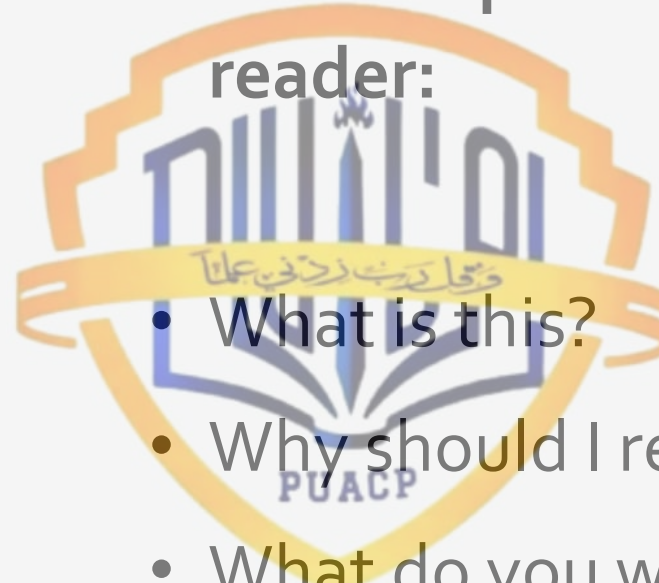
Introduction

- This chapter starts with a few short introductory paragraphs.
- The primary aim of these paragraphs is to get the reader familiar with the report.
- It has two parts:
 - 1. A general introduction to the topic you will be discussing
 - 2. Your Thesis Statement



Structure and Approach

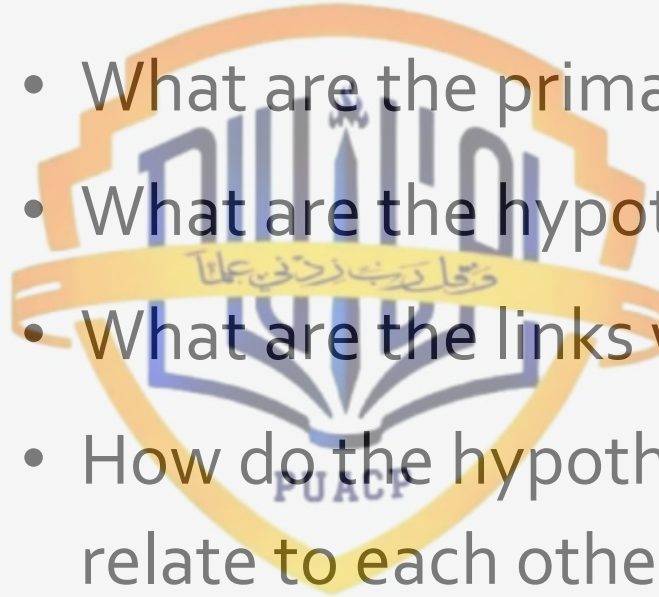
- The introduction is the broad beginning of the paper that answers three important questions for the reader:



- What is this?
- Why should I read it?
- What do you want me to think about?

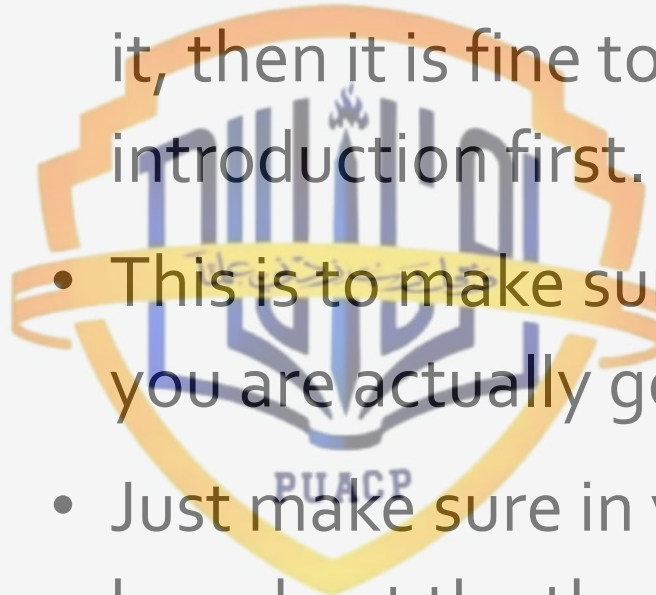
Feature of Introduction

- Why is this problem important
- How does study relates to previous work in the research area
- What are the primary and secondary objectives
- What are the hypothesis
- What are the links with the theory
- How do the hypothesis and research design relate to each other
- What are the theoretical and practical effect of the study



When do I do it?

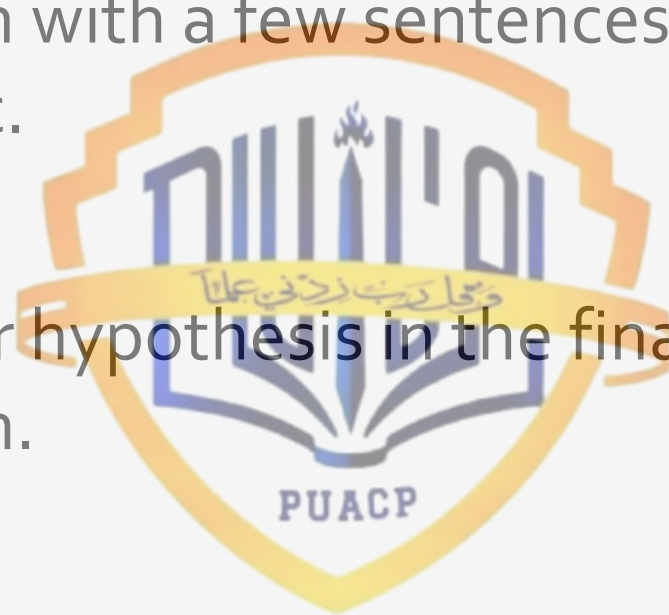
- Many books recommend writing your introduction last, after you finish your project.
- If you have written a good outline and stick to it, then it is fine to start writing your introduction first.
- This is to make sure that you introduce what you are actually going to say.
- Just make sure in your proofreading that you have kept the thread consistent throughout the paper.



How do I do it?

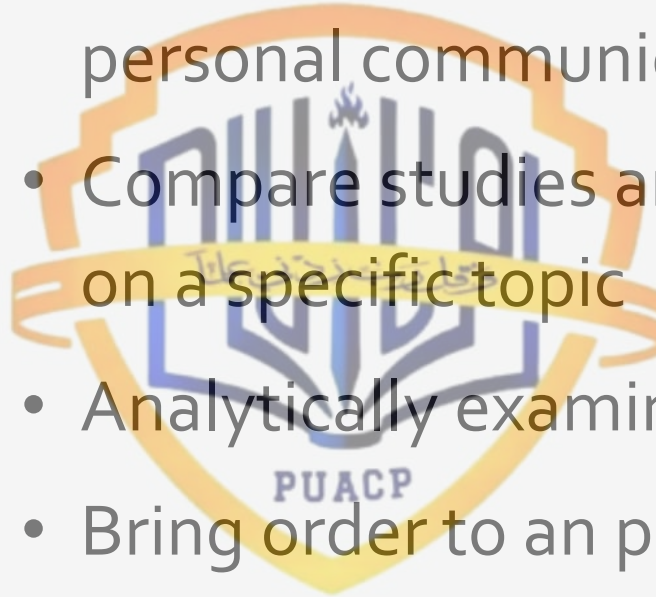
- Start with a couple of sentences that introduce your topic to your reader.
- You do not have to give too much detailed information; save that for the body of your paper.
- Make these sentences as interesting as you can.
- Through them, you can hook a reader and get them very interested in the line of thinking you are going to develop in your project.
- state your thesis, which may be done in one or more sentences.

- The length of your introduction depends on the length and complexity of your project.
- Begin the opening paragraph with a few sentences containing supporting information about your topic.
- Place the thesis statement or hypothesis in the final sentence of your introduction's first paragraph.
- Continue your introduction by explaining your reader with the major points of your paper, and your objectives and results in a scientific paper, in the order they will appear.



Literature Review

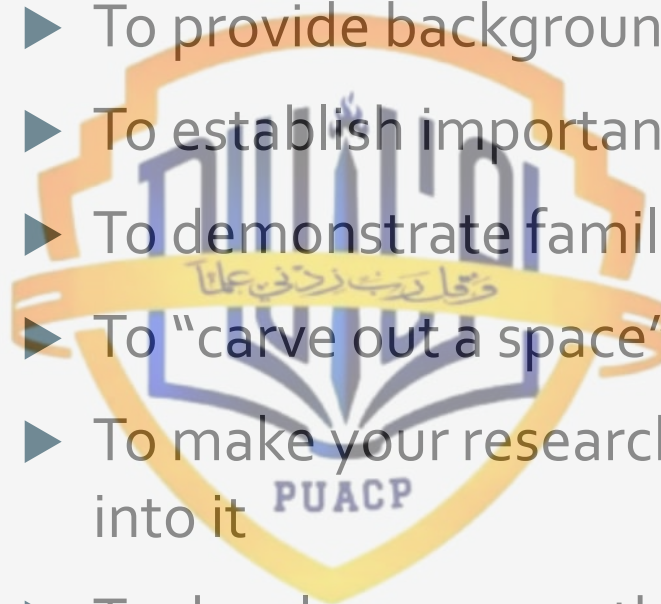
- A broad, comprehensive, in-depth, systematic, and critical review of scholarly publications, print materials, audiovisual materials and personal communications
- Compare studies and know “*what’s out there*” on a specific topic
- Analytically examine existing body of research
- Bring order to an plenty of information spread across too many places



Purpose of a Literature Review

The literature review is a critical look at the existing research that is significant to the work that you are carrying out.

- ▶ To provide background information
- ▶ To establish importance
- ▶ To demonstrate familiarity
- ▶ To “carve out a space” for further research
- ▶ To make your research problem clear and bring focus into it
- ▶ To develop your methodology
- ▶ To know where you are
- ▶ To have a broader knowledge in your area of research

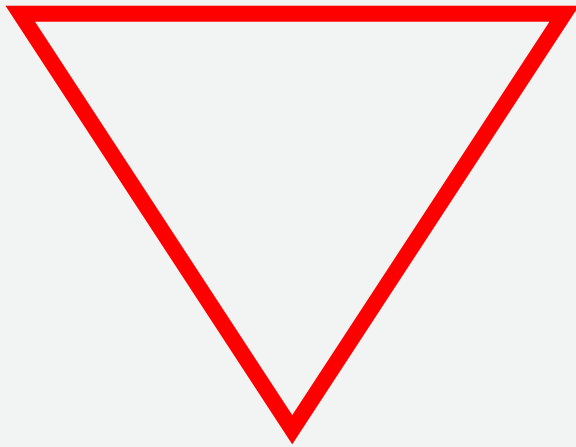


Sources

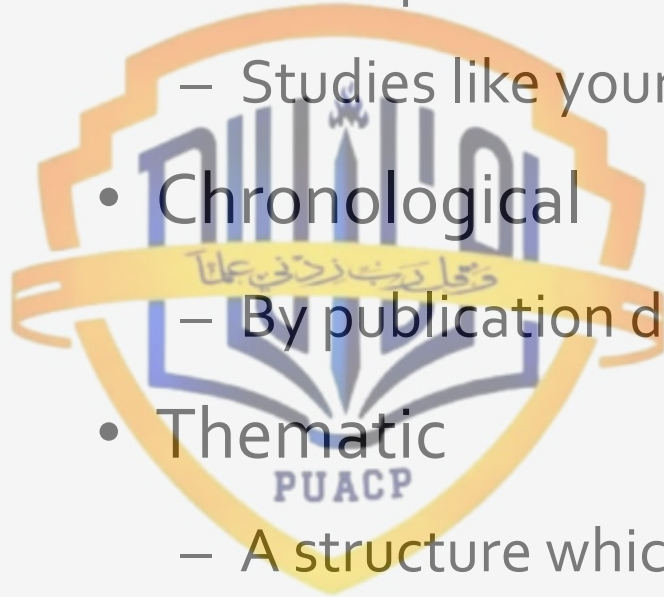
- Articles in Journals
- Books
- Internet
- Research Reports
- Government Documents
- Abstracts
- Reviews
- Unpublished Theses



Organization of literature review

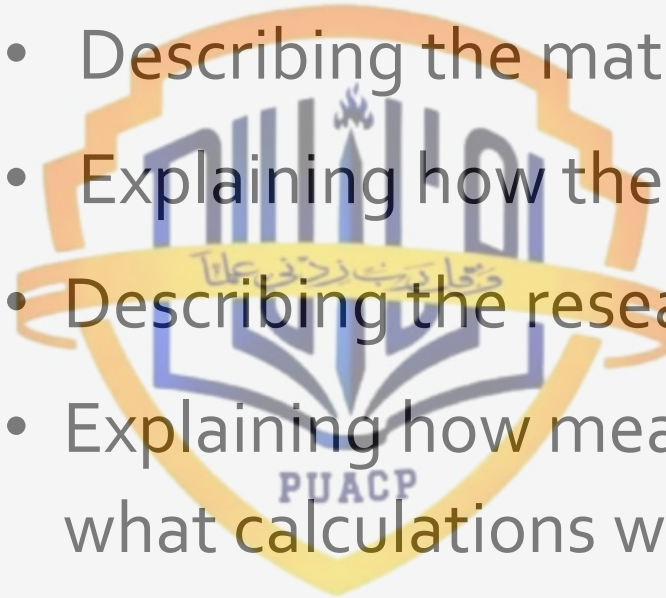


- A general organization looks like a funnel
 - Broader topics
 - Subtopics
 - Studies like yours
- Chronological
 - By publication date
- Thematic
 - A structure which considers different themes



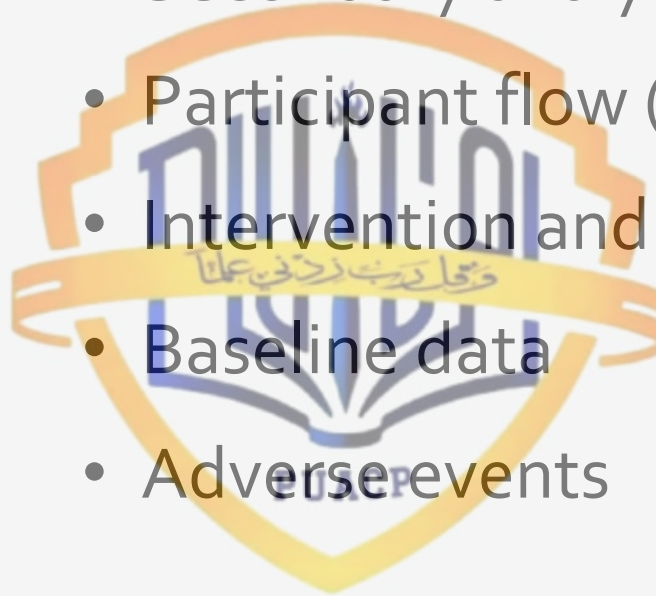
Methodology

- It describe in detail how the study was conducted
- It includes conceptual and operational definition of the variables used in the study
- Describing the materials used in the study
- Explaining how the materials were prepared
- Describing the research protocol
- Explaining how measurements were made and what calculations were performed
- Stating which statistical tests were done to analyze the data



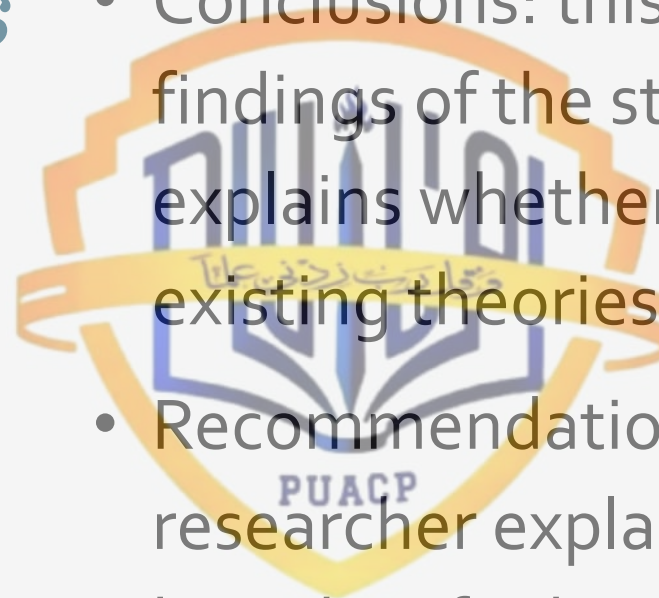
Results

- Defining the periods of study
- Statistics and data analysis
- Secondary analysis
- Participant flow (only in experiments)
- Intervention and manipulation of records
- Baseline data
- Adverse events



conclusions and recommendations

- This chapter starts with a few paragraphs summarizing what we did and found
- Conclusions: this section consists of key findings of the study. The researcher explains whether his findings support the existing theories or not.
- Recommendations: in this section the researcher explains the recommendations based on findings. Recommendations should not be based on his own beliefs which are not supported by his data.



References

- Acknowledges the work of previous scholars
- Reference should be accurate, complete and useful for future research



Various style manuals

- APA – American Psychological Association
- MLA – Modern Language Association
- Chicago Style – Chicago Manual of Style
- Harvard Referencing System
- CBE – Council of Biology Editors



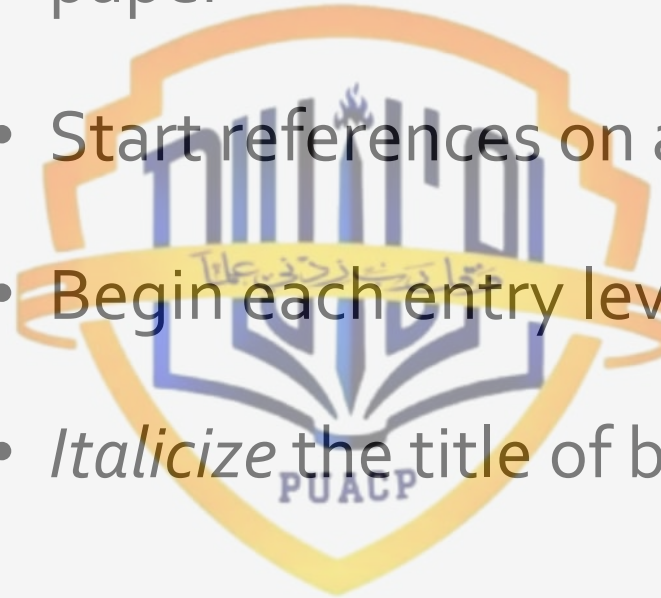
Reference should contain

- Name of the author
- Year of publication
- Journal, book, conference paper or other material in which it is published
- The publisher
- Place of publishing



Reference list

- Place the list of references cited at the end of the paper
- Start references on a new page
- Begin each entry level with the left margin
- *Italicize* the title of books, magazines, etc.



Reference list order

- Arrange sources alphabetically beginning with author's last name
- If author has more than one source, arrange entries by year, earliest first
- When an author appears both as a sole author and, in another citation as the first author of a group, list the one author entries first
- If no author given, begin entry with the title and alphabetize without counting a, an, or the
- Do not underline, italicize or use quote marks for titles used instead of an author name

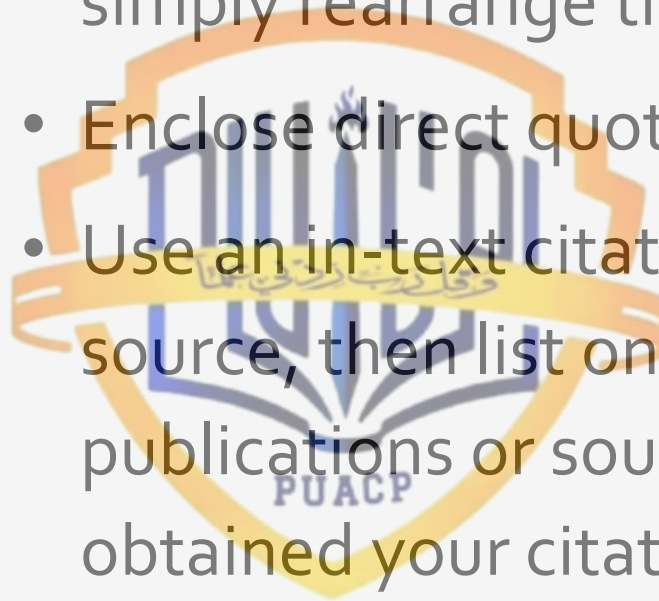
Plagiarism

Plagiarism is the use of the words and/or ideas of another person without acknowledging the source.



To avoid plagiarism

- If you use another person's idea or paraphrase another person's words, be sure to use your own language and style of writing — don't simply rearrange the words.
- Enclose direct quotations in quotation marks
- Use an in-text citation to acknowledge the source, then list on a reference page the publications or sources from which you obtained your citations.



THANKS

